

process, and you have the option to use an HTML editor or a Wiki based editor.

True to the collaborative origins of a wiki, any visitor to the site can edit the contents or add a new page, which is not really desirable in a blog.

Changes to the platform can be made using the Settings links on the top right corner. Under page style you can change the page colour scheme. Under the Page Manage link you can specify the users who can modify the contents of the bliki. If you prefer to be the only one doing the editing (as is the case with blog) you should change the Edit-Lock entry to Admin only. To ensure that all pages that you create retain these settings, visit the Policy link. Here you can change the “New page Default Edit-lock-type” to Admin only. Also enable the “Deny anonymous Create New Page” to avoid visitors from creating pages on your bliki. Under the CSS link you can insert custom CSS code, if you know what you are doing. Under the Menu Page and Default Page you can edit the contents of these two pages, which are also editable by using the Edit Tab on the right hand top corner of every page.

Concluding Remarks

As a technology demonstrator, atwiki.com impresses us—the potential of a bliki is quite evident after using it. The language on the site is (refreshingly) childish, and reading through the FAQ is hilarious. Nevertheless, users with knowledge of CSS can create a layout that they would be comfortable with. While it may not be suitable for professional use, from a personal blogger’s view—the large Google ad notwithstanding—Atwiki offers a bit more than an ordinary blog.

Other providers worth a look are wikidot.com and netcipia.net, with the latter offering a much better implementation of the bliki concept than atwiki.com.